

Cloud Storage

There is no Cloud. It's just someone else's computer.



The definition of cloud storage also analyses the meaning of cloud computing, so to understand what it is you must first clarify this term: cloud computing is the use of computing resources available on demand through the Internet, including data processing and transmission services; specifically, cloud storage is the use of cloud computing for

storing files. Cloud storage is therefore the most widespread technology of cloud computing, thanks to the spread of useful services for the end user. Cloud storage that you can access remotely online either for free or for a fee allows you to increase file security and reliability in a single service that stores and encrypts all files on a PC. Many companies offer free plans for cloud data storage. However, in terms of size, functionality, management capabilities and service level assurance, free services are often too limited for business use, which may have specific needs depending on the type of use. Therefore, it is very often recommended for professional business use to purchase cloud storage services that offer more storage space and additional security services. There are dozens of services that fall under that umbrella term (cloud storage) and many users interchangeably call them cloud backup, online storage, online drives, online backup, file hosting, file storage and so on. At its simplest, it is a secure virtual space that you will usually access via your browser or an application (or a mobile app). The actual location of your files is usually in a data center somewhere, in a server, on a hard drive or solid-state drive.

Best cloud storage services of 2020: Top providers for storing your data online

1. [Icedrive](#) – Best mobile cloud storage service
2. [pCloud](#) – Best cloud storage service with lifetime access
3. [Zoolz](#) – Best for high-volume, long-term cloud storage
4. [IDrive](#) – Best cloud storage service for backups
5. [Sync](#) – Best for heavily regulated industries
6. [LiveDrive](#) – Best for remote team collaboration
7. [Google Drive](#) – Best free cloud storage service
8. [Microsoft OneDrive](#) – Best cloud storage service for PC power users
9. [Apple's iCloud](#) – Best cloud storage service for Apple power users
10. [Dropbox](#) – Most popular cloud storage service

Advantages

Data storage saving: By storing your data online you are reducing the burden of your hard disk, which means you are eventually saving disk space and cost. For backups that need quick and/or frequent restores, consider using the vendor's hot storage as retrieval is fast and the most cost-effective. For long-term storage, consider moving redundant data to archive storage, especially if you plan to keep the backups for years.

World Wide accessibility: This is the main advantage of online data storage. You can access your data anywhere in the world. You don't have to carry your hard disk, pen drive or any other storage device.

Data safety: You cannot trust your HDD and storage device every time because it can crash anytime. In order to make your data safe from such hazards you can keep it online.

Security: Most of the online storage sites provide better security avoiding cyber crimes : Malware and Ransomware.

Easy sharing: you can share data with your friends fast, easily and in secured manner.

Data recovery: online data storage sites provide quick recovery of your files and folders. This makes them safe and secure.

Automatic backup: you can even schedule automatic backup of your personal computer in order to avoid manual backup of files.

Disadvantages

Vulnerability to attacks: Storing data in the cloud may pose serious challenges of information theft since in the cloud every data of a company is online. Security breach is something that even the best encrypting organizations have suffered from and it's a potential risk in the cloud as well. Although advanced security measures are deployed on the cloud, still storing confidential data in the cloud can be a risky affair.

Network connectivity dependency: Cloud Computing is entirely dependent on the Internet. This direct tie-up with the Internet means that a company needs to have reliable and consistent Internet service as well as a fast connection and bandwidth to reap the benefits of Cloud Computing.

Downtime: Downtime is considered as one of the biggest potential downsides of using Cloud Computing. The cloud providers may sometimes face technical outages that can happen due to various reasons, such as loss of power, low Internet connectivity, data centers going out of service for maintenance, etc. This can lead to a temporary downtime in the cloud service.

Complexity of Migration: When in need to migrate from one cloud platform to another, a company might face some serious challenges because of the differences between vendor platforms. Hosting and running the applications of the current cloud platform on some other platform may cause support issues, configuration complexities, and additional expenses. The company data might also be left vulnerable to security attacks due to compromises that might have been made during migrations.

Conclusion

Transitioning from the comfort of using local disk to cloud storage can be stressful, but it's happening more and more every day. The benefits of cloud storage over local disk are many. The drawbacks are few and can be easily managed.

Questions :

1) These statements are false correct them .

a- *Cloud storage* is broader in meaning than *cloud computing* .

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b) Cloud computing offers only storage space.

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c)Free online storage is recommended for professional businesses.

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2) Pick out synonymous expressions that can be used interchangeably with *cloud storage*.

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3) Find expressions showing that online storage isn't part of your desktop hardware.

Line4....., line8.....line16last line

4) Find equivalents :

*The state of being no longer used or needed :

*A malicious software designed to block access to a computer system until a sum of money is paid :

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*The collection of historical documents or records : **ADVANTAGES**

*Convert information or data into a code to prevent cyber attacks :.....

* A period when a power supply is closed down : **DISADVANTAGES**

WRITING : Explain the following saying : " *There is no cloud. It's just someone else's computer* ".

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